ORGANIC FARMING

The discovery of antibiotics in the 20th century brought remarkable changes to modern medicine, enabling people to live longer, healthier lives. But in the last generation, new strains of bacteria have emerged that are resistant to these wonder drugs. One of the main causes of resistance is the overuse of antibiotics. That includes drugs given to commercially raised livestock, and this can lead to serious threats to human health if the animal is diseased. Hence, organic farming - which means raising animals and crops without using drugs or chemical fertilizers - is gradually becoming popular.

New Horizons is such a farm in the American state of North Carolina. This farm is raising meat without the use of chemicals. Eleven-year-old Chance Lorraine likes to show visitors around. Here, on 20 hectares, his parents raise organic vegetables, pigs, Black Angus beef cattle, and chickens. There are also water buffalo. But what really sets New Horizons apart from commercial livestock farms are three metal silos near the pastures. "We keep feed in all three of these. That's cow feed, that's chicken feed, and the other one is pig feed," says Chance. The feed is special because of what it doesn't have: no growth hormones, no animal by-products, no chemicals against worms, and no antibiotics. The animals in the field that eat this feed eventually end up in cold storage at the New Horizons Farm store.

EXERCISE 1: Find words or phrases in the passage which mean the same as:

	COLUMN A	COLUMN B
a)	worthy of notice; extraordinary; easily noticed	
b)	a group of organisms within a species that differ in trivial ways from similar groups	
c)	not affected by the action of something;	
d)	produced in large quantities for financial gain	
e)	domestic farm animals, such as cattle, horses and sheep, especially when raised for profit	
f)	as a consequence; therefore; thus	
g)	moving, changing, etc., slowly and by degrees	
h)	breed, grow	
i)	guide or escort someone to various areas of a place or building *(phrase)*	
j)	make something or someone different from other similar things *(phrase)*	
k)	land covered with grass and grazed by, or suitable for grazing by, livestock	
l)	food, especially for animals	
m)	a small elongated soft animal, without a backbone	
n)	at the very end; finally; after a long time or delay	
o)	space or area reserved for keeping things for future use	

EXERCISE 2: Choose the correct answer according to the passage.

1. According to the passage, over the last fifty years or so.....

A) bacteria have developed that are not affected by today's antibiotics
B) there has been a sharp increase in organic farming across the world
C) North Carolina has become the centre of organic farming
D) a huge number of antibiotics have been developed
E) the Lorraines have gradually changed to organic farming methods

2. The author states that one reason for the growth in organic farming is.....

A) higher productivity from livestock
B) cost savings over intensive farming methods
C) the government support provided for private enterprises
D) fears over the consequences of excessive use of antibiotics
E) an epidemic of worms infesting livestock

3. According to the description in the passage, the food for livestock at New Horizons.....

A) contains animal products for added protein
B) is treated with antibiotics
C) contains medicine to treat worm infestations
D) promotes animal growth through the use of hormones
E) is totally natural

EXERCISE 3: Complete the sentences by selecting words from Column B in EXERCISE 1.

1. I'll leave you with our receptionist now, and she'll.....you.....our offices, canteen, and other facilities.
2. It is important to paint exterior walls with weather.....paint, such as an oil-based type.
3. There is currently a national shortage of social workers....., high salaries are now being offered for this kind of work.
4. There have been.....advances in telecommunications in the last century.
5. He grew mushrooms in his garage as a hobby before he started growing them